

SYSTEM DESIGN — RESOURCE GUIDE

@techbyshreyas · From Zero to Interview-Ready

YouTube Playlists

Gaurav Sen — System Design Playlist

Best free starting point for fundamentals — methodical, builds each concept on the last.

youtube.com/playlist?list=PLMCXHnjXnTnvo6aISjVkgxV-VH6EPyvoX

Hello Interview — System Design Playlist

Rated “goat prep” across Reddit/Blind — clean, modern mock interview walkthroughs.

youtube.com/playlist?list=PL5q3E8eRUieWtYLMRU3z94-vGRcwKr9tM

ByteByteGo (Alex Xu) — System Design Playlist

Most-cited channel on every prep thread — animated, visual breakdowns of real company systems.

youtube.com/playlist?list=PLCRMle5FDPsd0gVs500xeOewfySTsmEjf

Books

Designing Data-Intensive Applications — Martin Kleppmann

The single most-respected reference in senior-level threads. Official book page with buy links (all major bookstores) below — also available via O'Reilly online subscription and as an Audible audiobook.

[https://0-lucas.github.io/digital-garden/99.-Books/Martin-Kleppmann---Designing-Data-Intensive-Applications_-O'Reilly-Media-\(20](https://0-lucas.github.io/digital-garden/99.-Books/Martin-Kleppmann---Designing-Data-Intensive-Applications_-O'Reilly-Media-(20)

System Design Interview: An Insider's Guide (Vol 1 & 2) — Alex Xu

Interview-focused, practical, most-recommended alongside DDIA. Official ByteByteGo site has purchase links for both volumes plus the newsletter, which shares free system design PDFs and diagrams periodically.

<https://bytebytego.com/>

Note: We're linking only to official sources for these books. Piracy/"free PDF" sites for commercially sold books aren't included — support the authors so they keep making free content too.

Free GitHub Repos

System Design Primer

The most-cited free resource across every prep discussion. Covers scaling, caching, load balancing, databases end to end, with practice questions.

<https://github.com/donnemartin/system-design-primer>

Awesome System Design Resources

Curated list aggregating articles, videos, and real-world case studies.

<https://github.com/madd86/awesome-system-design>

Company Engineering Blogs

Razorpay Engineering

Real production problems from an Indian fintech giant.

<https://razorpay.com/blog/engineering/>

Swiggy Bytes (Engineering)

Scale problems from Indian food-tech at scale.

<https://bytes.swiggy.com/>

Uber Engineering

Widely referenced in interviews for dispatch, maps, and real-time systems.

<https://www.uber.com/blog/engineering/>

Netflix Tech Blog

CDN, streaming, and microservices at massive scale.

<https://netflixtechblog.com/>

More Free YouTube Channels

CodeKarle

Ex-Meta engineer, real interview-style scenario walkthroughs.

<https://www.youtube.com/c/codeKarle>

Arpit Bhayani (Asli Engineering)

Strong for databases and caching depth. Free YouTube content well-regarded; his paid course has mixed reviews online — check for yourself before buying.

<https://www.youtube.com/@AsliEngineering>

ByteMonk

Case studies like designing global payment systems.

<https://www.youtube.com/@ByteMonk>

freeCodeCamp.org

Free full-length system design courses in one sitting.

<https://www.youtube.com/@freecodecamp>

Compiled by @techbyshreyas — follow for more career & interview resources.